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Elon Musk says he's
bringing back Vine's
archive

ME OV
Elon Musk says he's bringing back Vine — sort of. The X owner [announced](#) over the weekend that the company discovered the [video archive](#) for the popular short-form video app, [thought to have been deleted](#), and is working to restore user access.

Vine — something of a precursor to today's TikTok, but with only six-second long looping videos — [was acquired by Twitter back in October 2012](#) for \$30 million to expand the social media platform's video ambitions. Unfortunately for Vine creators and fans, the company fumbled the app's potential and decided to [shut down Vine in 2016](#) by limiting all new uploads. The following year, it was fully discontinued, though a [user archive](#) remained for a time.

▶ YES NO
Despite no longer having an App Store presence, Vine still has a place in the internet's collective cultural consciousness. Through online compilations of the best Vines uploaded to YouTube, and through the careers of numerous creators who got their start on Vine, the company lives on to some extent, and its content continues to be discovered by new generations.

Musk himself seemed interested in bringing back Vine after [acquiring Twitter in October 2022](#). In [a poll posted](#) on the social media app, he asked Twitter's users, "Bring back Vine?" to which nearly 70% responded "yes." [Axios reported at the time](#) that Twitter had devoted some engineers to working on the Vine reboot, but nothing ever came of it.

IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH

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Elon Musk  
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Grok Imagine is AI Vine!

Btw, we recently found the Vine video archive (thought it had been deleted) and are working on restoring user access, so you can post them if you want.

5:32 PM · Aug 2, 2025



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It's unclear whether Musk has any ambitions for Vine beyond getting its archive back online, however. In the same post about restoring Vine, he also touted that Grok's new video-creation feature, Grok Imagine, also available to X Premium+ subscribers, is "AI Vine." That suggests that his interests in video creation no longer lie with human creativity, but in human-directed AI prompting.

Whether or not Musk will actually deliver on the promise remains to be seen, as the X post could have just been another way to draw attention to Grok AI, rather than being representative of a real effort inside the company to make old Vines available for reposting.

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AI

AI agents aren't the 'new Google,' says Airbnb CEO

Sarah Perez — 8:37 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

After a second-quarter earnings [beat](#), Airbnb CEO Brian Chesky shared his thoughts on the company's AI strategy, cautioning investors that AI chatbots can't yet be thought of as the "new Google." That is, AI chatbots, while potentially

driving new leads to the travel and services business, aren't entirely a replacement for the referrals that the dominant search engine brings.

At least not at this time.

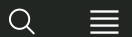
"I think we're still kind of feeling out the space," the exec told



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custom-built startups designed for specific applications, as well as other incumbents that have made the shift to AI.

"One of the things we've noticed is it's not enough to just have ... the best model. You have to be able to tune the model and build a custom interface for the right application. And I think that's the key," he said.



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The company told investors it will look to take advantage of AI in a number of ways.

Airbnb shared during the call that its AI customer service agent in the U.S. reduced the percentage of guests contacting a human agent by 15%, for instance. This was actually harder than tackling the lower-hanging fruit involving travel planning and inspiration, Chesky said, because AI agents performing customer service can't hallucinate. They have to be accurate and helpful at all times.

Airbnb's customer service agent was built using 13 different models and trained on tens of thousands of conversations, and is currently available in English in the U.S. This year, Airbnb will roll it out to more languages, and next year, it will become more personalized and agentic. That means it would be able to understand if someone reaches out to cancel a reservation; not only would it be able to tell them how to do so, but it could also do it for them. The agent could also help plan and book trips.

Plus, AI will come to Airbnb's search next year, the CEO said.

However, the company has not fully fleshed out its plans for working with third-party AI agents, although it's considering it. Users still need an Airbnb account to make a booking.

Because of this, Chesky doesn't think agentic AI would turn its business into a commodity, the way that booking flights has become. Instead, he sees AI as "potentially interesting lead generation" for the company.

"I think the key thing is going to be for us to lead and become the first place for people to book travel on Airbnb. As far as whether or not we integrate with AI agents, I think that's something that we're certainly open to," he said.

Airbnb beat analysts' expectations in the quarter with revenue of \$3.1 billion and earnings per share of \$1.03, but the stock [dropped](#) on its forecast of slower growth in the second half of the year.

Topics: [AI](#) [AI agents](#) [Airbnb](#) [Apps](#)

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The backlash against Duolingo going ‘AI-first’ didn’t even matter

Amanda Silberling — 8:32 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: [DUOLINGO](#)

Duolingo [announced](#) on Wednesday that it beat its quarterly revenue estimates, even though the company faced widespread backlash for choosing to embrace generative AI over human workers. Duolingo stock rose [almost 30%](#) on the news.

In April, CEO Luis von Ahn [shared](#) that Duolingo would become an “AI-first” company, phasing out its use of contract workers. He also discouraged teams from hiring more employees, unless the team is unable to automate more of its work. With the use of generative AI, Duolingo introduced 148 new language courses, more than doubling its previous offerings.

“Without AI, it would take us decades to scale our content to more learners,” von Ahn wrote at the time. “We owe it to our learners to get them this content ASAP.”

While some Duolingo users have argued that these AI features are making the app worse, the company’s financial metrics tell a different story. Now the company [anticipates](#) making over \$1 billion in revenue this year, and daily active users have grown 40% year-over-year. The growth is significant but falls in the lower range of the company’s estimates of growing between 40% and 45%, which an investor brought up to von Ahn on Wednesday’s quarterly earnings call.

“The reason we came [in] towards the lower end was because I said some stuff about AI, and I didn’t give enough context. Because of that, we got some backlash on social media,” von Ahn said. “The most important thing is we wanted to make the sentiment on our social media positive. We stopped posting edgy posts and started posting things that would get our sentiment more positive. That has worked.”

On TikTok, the top comments on Duolingo’s videos often remain criticisms of the company’s AI approach. Snarky commenters will ask if videos with multiple people in them are made with AI, to which Duolingo will reply, “Nope. Made by our great team!”

But even if public sentiment toward Duolingo has shifted, its bottom line has not ... and from the company’s perspective, that’s what matters.

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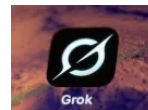


The backlash against Duolingo going ‘AI-first’ didn’t even matter

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IN BRIEF



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Amanda Silberling

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Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She has also written for...

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